



'KL'assy knock: K. L. Rahul excelled with a remarkable century in the first Test in Centurion, while Virat Kohli showed good form. Other Indian batters struggled in South Africa. PTI

second. Instead, he played a forgettable shot to the first ball he faced and was back warming the cold bench in the changing room, watching two youngsters, Yashasvi Jaiswal and Shivam Dube, toy with the Afghanistan bowling attack. Dube's comeback to the T20 team tells you what giving confidence to a player can do. His hitting is something that Indian cricket lovers are aware of, but it was his bowling, where he was hitting the deck rather than floating the ball on a length, that was the eye-opener.

In his previous opportunities, he looked a bit lost, but this time around, he seems a lot more confident and is hitting the ball out of the ground regularly and easily. If he continues to perform well at the IPL, he gives himself a very good chance of being in the team for the T20

World Cup in June.

It's early days, of course, and one doesn't know when Ishan Kishan, who asked to be allowed to go home from South Africa, is going to make himself available again. Rahul Dravid, the coach of the team, has very clearly said that he has to play in the Ranji Trophy and show his form to be considered for selection. Dravid also very categorically and firmly debunked the rumours that Kishan was left out because of disciplinary reasons. Hopefully, that will set the matter to rest and not further sully a young man's name, which was done by some ill-founded speculation after his name was found missing in the Indian squad for the first two Test matches against England.

Players work very hard to play the game at whatever level, so it's incumbent on the media to get their facts right rather than speculate and spoil a young man's name. Kishan is a rare talent, and Indian cricket lovers should back him to come back to scoring and entertaining us sooner rather than later.



Bringing back Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli for the three-match T20I series against Afghanistan made little sense.